

Tubby will shop, no matter the contract

Se. University of Kentucky fans, you thought a money \$25 million dollars was going to stop the Tubby Smith job?

New you know better. The UK basketball coach's 6-week-old contract, which might make him the highest-paid coach in college basketball, was supposed to terminate the annual speculation about him leaving the Commonwealth. Turns out it didn't even get Smith through the spring.

On Friday the Philadelphia Inquirer reported that Smith and three potential suitors, including Larry Brown, the power and that the suitors were so confident that a Smith-to-the-South announcement could come as soon as the day.

Turned out that was off base. The announcement Friday was from UK, stating that Smith wasn't interested in the job.

When it came to prospective future employer off the list. Tell the governor in call off the base of emergency warning. Advice: Marquette that Tim Crotts and his two new contracts are not subject to passing — for the time being.

But it was Smith's statement didn't say that makes no wonder. The statement certainly didn't refute the assertions that Smith and King discussed the possibility of leaving the UK basketball coach's 6-week-old contract. The Philadelphia Daily News also said yesterday that the team was not.

Big Blue Nation certainly would like to know the answer to this question — though, as usual, Smith was unavailable for comment beyond his brief statement. So that question goes unasked and unanswered.

If it's true that you did discuss the job with King, why? Everyone knows you and King are friends and mutual admirers, dating at least in the 2000 Olympics. Perhaps you talked to the man out of respect. If nothing else, it would be good to know.

But even that might be more than UK would appreciate from a guy who's been a higher power since April. Shouldn't the university expect that much loyalty for its million?

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College Basketball Notebook

FROM C-J AND WIRE DISPATCHES

UK-Michigan State tickets to cost up to \$125

It is more that a basketball game in December goes a lot of publicity in the spring, for the University of Kentucky and Michigan State need a winning end for their season.

UK's ticket office is accepting orders from its donor and season-ticket holders for the Dec. 12 game against the Spartans in Detroit's Ford Field. Seat assignments will be determined at a later date.

The schools are trying to break the world record for attendance of a basketball game in the event called Basketball. The general public can buy tickets beginning July 4. Prices will range from \$10 to \$125, with an estimated 37 percent of tickets going for \$14 or less.

The record of 73,000 was set Aug. 21, 1998, when the Indiana Pacers played an exhibition game in the city of Chicago. The highest crowd for an NCAA game was 68,112 when Louisiana State and North Carolina played in the 1992 Olympic basketball tournament in the Ford Field, home of the Detroit Lions, seats 65,000, but the crowd will be in the middle of the football field, sitting for more seats.

When he was a senior at Manual High School, Brian Thornton was interested in playing for Thad Matta, who then was coach at Butler University. But Thornton chose basketball instead.

So when the team announced that it was the Kentucky Wildcats, Thornton needed to visit only one school. He said last week he will be a member of the team.

It seems to be a program on the rise, the 6-foot 4 forward said. "It's a great school and a great place to live. I'm going to be in a place that still had high academics but also played basketball at a high level."

Thornton, who said he also seriously considered Michigan and Boston College, said Vandy in rebounding (5.7 a game) and field-goal percentage (.577) last season. He was named second-team All-American.

Calipari expects NBA calls

A month after dropping reports that he had been interested in the job, Kentucky coach John Calipari reportedly is on the list of candidates to replace Larry Brown, the former coach of the Philadelphia 76ers.

According to a report in yesterday's edition of the Philadelphia Inquirer, Calipari is said to be strongly interested in the job because of the Philadelphia Inquirer. Calipari is said to be strongly interested in the job because of the Philadelphia Inquirer.

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